



Throw Hijackers to the Curb!

*People are definitely a company's greatest asset.
It doesn't make any difference whether the product is cars or cosmetics.
A company is only as good as the people it keeps.*

~ MARY KAY ASH

YOUR CASTLE IS MISMANAGED

Your castle is your business. If you put crooks in the castle, expect trouble. Returning to our chess analogy, the rook—or the castle—represents the people you put in your business. This includes employees, partners and investors, and advisers.

THE BUSINESS MARRIAGE: PARTNERS

A business partner is like being married. It either works fabulously or it ends in fiery divorce.

Three years ago, Jim and Mike were drinking beer at a bar and a legendary idea was born that compelled them to start a business together. Their only consideration for the union was their excitement. They agreed to do a 50/50 profit split and zealously began. Mike finds their first client, while Jim finds the second. Within a few months, their client base expands to 28, enough for both of them to draw a profit and quit their daytime jobs.

After two years, Jim's time on the job and quality of work starts to suffer. Not that Mike knows what Jim is doing every minute of the day, but he notices something that concerns him. For every four clients Mike brings to the company, Jim brings one, and sometimes, none. He later learns that Jim